

User Manual

A Complete Guide for Farmers, Buyers, and Administrators

Covers both access channels — the installable app (smartphone) and the SMS command channel (any phone, no data required) — and every role: Farmer, Buyer, and Administrator.

Course	CSCD602 — Advanced Software Engineering, Capstone Project
Group	Angry Nerds
Project title	FarmConnect Ghana
Document version	1.0
Date	12 August 2026
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1. Getting Started

1.1 What you need

- Any smartphone with a modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge) — **no app-store download needed**; or any basic phone that can send/receive SMS.
- A phone number that can receive SMS (used for OTP login and, for farmers, for order alerts).
- Farmers additionally need a registered Mobile Money account (MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash, or AirtelTigo Money).

1.2 Opening the app

- 1 Open the live application URL in your phone's browser (see the README/Links.txt for the exact address).
- 2 Optional but recommended: your browser will offer "**Add to Home Screen**" / "**Install app**" — accept it. FarmConnect then opens like any other app icon and keeps working (for previously-seen data) even with a weak connection.
- 3 Choose English or Twi from the language toggle at any time — it applies immediately, no restart.

1.3 Creating an account

- 1 Enter your phone number.
- 2 You'll receive a 6-digit code by SMS — enter it within 5 minutes.
- 3 First time only: choose **Farmer** or **Buyer**. This cannot be changed later from inside the app — contact an administrator if you picked the wrong one.
- 4 You're in. Returning users just repeat steps 1–2 — the app remembers your role.

NO PASSWORD, EVER

FarmConnect never asks for a password — only your phone number and the one-time code sent to it. If anything on-screen asks you for a password, it is not part of FarmConnect.

2. Farmer Guide

2.1 Link your Mobile Money details (required first step)

Immediately after choosing "Farmer," you'll be asked to link Mobile Money — this cannot be skipped, because buyers need it to pay you directly.

- 1 Choose your network: MTN, Telecel, or AirtelTigo.
- 2 Enter the phone number registered to that Mobile Money account.
- 3 Enter the account name exactly as it shows on your Mobile Money — buyers will double-check this before paying.
- 4 Save. You can update these details any time from **Profile** → **Mobile Money**.

2.2 Your Home screen

Shows a personalised greeting, a 3-stat summary (active listings, pending orders, total earned), your recent listings with status badges, and a big "+ **New listing**" button. A quick-action card also opens the **Advisor** chat directly from Home (farmers don't have a separate Advisor tab — see §2.7).

2.3 Creating a listing

- 1 Tap + **New listing**.
- 2 Add one or more photos of your produce (tap to use your camera or photo library).
- 3 Choose the crop type, then enter quantity (kg) and price per kg.
- 4 Set the harvest/availability date.
- 5 Tap "**Use current location**" to set your farm's location (buyers filter/sort by distance) — or type your region.
- 6 If you belong to a co-op and want this listing to show under the co-op's name instead of just yours, check "**Sell as my co-op**."
- 7 Tap **Publish listing**. It appears in the buyer marketplace immediately, status *Active*.

From **Listings**, you can edit any of your own listings' details, or remove one (it moves to *Removed* — no data is deleted).

2.4 Handling an order & getting paid

This is the most important flow to get right — read it carefully.

- 1 A buyer places an order on your listing — you get an in-app and SMS notification. The listing is now *Pending* (other buyers can't order it while a deal is in progress).
- 2 The buyer sends the money directly to your Mobile Money number using their own phone (their MoMo app or USSD code) — this happens completely outside FarmConnect; you will see a normal Mobile Money SMS from your network exactly as usual.
- 3 The buyer then submits a transaction ID inside the app. You get a notification: "*Verify this transaction ID.*"
- 4 Open the order and **check that transaction ID against your own Mobile Money SMS/history**. This is the one manual check that keeps FarmConnect free and safe — nobody else does it for you.
- 5 If it matches: tap **Confirm payment**. If it doesn't match anything in your history: tap **Reject payment** and add a short note — the buyer can then correct and resubmit, or raise a dispute.
- 6 Once the buyer collects/receives the produce and confirms delivery in the app, the order is complete and the listing is marked *Sold*.

WHY THIS STEP EXISTS

FarmConnect does not run a payment gateway and never touches your money — see the SRS §9.1 for why. This means the money reaches your Mobile Money account exactly as if a friend sent it to you directly, with no delay and no platform fee taken out — but it also means you are the one person who can see your own Mobile Money history, so only you can confirm a payment really happened.

2.5 Disputes

If a buyer believes they paid but you rejected the payment, they can raise a dispute. An administrator will review it and decide — you'll be notified either way, and the outcome (order proceeds, or is cancelled and your listing reopens) is final.

2.6 Co-ops

- 1 From **Profile** → **My Co-op**, either **create** a co-op (you become its leader and get a short join code to share) or **join** one using a code a leader shared with you.
- 2 You can belong to only one co-op at a time.
- 3 Leaving: if you're a regular member, you simply leave. If you're the leader, leadership automatically passes to whoever joined earliest among the remaining members; if you were the only member, the co-op is dissolved.

2.7 Ratings, Prices & the Advisor

- **Ratings** — once an order is delivered, both you and the buyer can rate each other 1–5 stars. Your trust score and rating count update immediately and show on your listings.
- **Prices tab** — live per-crop prices with a % change indicator, refreshed every few minutes.
- **Advisor** — reached via the quick-action card on Home: ask about pests, weather, or best practice in plain English or Twi; attach a photo of a sick-looking crop for a photo-based diagnosis. If your location is on, the advice accounts for the current weather near you.

3. Buyer Guide

3.1 The Marketplace

Your home tab. Search by crop name, filter by category (Grains/Vegetables/Fruits/Tubers), and each card shows the crop, farmer's name and region, quantity, price per kg, distance from you, and the farmer's trust score/verified badge.

3.2 Placing an order

- 1 Tap a listing to see full details — more photos, harvest date, exact quantity available, and the farmer's rating history.
- 2 Choose how much you want (up to what's available) and tap **Order**.
- 3 You'll see a total that includes a flat delivery fee, and — critically — the **farmer's Mobile Money details** (network, number, account name) to pay to.

3.3 Paying & confirming

- 1 Open your own Mobile Money app or dial the USSD code for your network, and send the exact total shown to the number FarmConnect displayed. **Double-check the account name matches** before sending.
- 2 Your network will text you a transaction ID/reference for the transfer, as it always does.
- 3 Back in FarmConnect, tap "**I've paid — submit**" and enter the phone number you paid from and the transaction ID. The order status becomes *Payment submitted*.
- 4 Wait for the farmer to confirm (usually quick — it's their money arriving). If they reject it (wrong ID, or they genuinely haven't received it yet), you can correct and resubmit, or if you're sure you paid correctly, raise a dispute for an administrator to review.
- 5 Once you actually receive the produce, open the order and tap **Confirm delivery**. This closes the order and lets both of you rate each other.

ONLY PAY AFTER YOU SEE THE FARMER'S REAL MOBILE MONEY DETAILS ON THE ORDER SCREEN

FarmConnect will never ask you to pay into any account other than the one shown on your specific order. Never send money based on a phone number given to you outside the app.

3.4 Orders, Prices & the Advisor

- **Orders tab** — every order you've placed, with its current status, from *Pending* through to *Delivered* (or *Cancelled*).

- **Prices tab** — the same live price feed farmers see, useful for knowing whether an asking price is fair.
- **Advisor tab** — the same AI advisory chat available to farmers (buyers can ask about produce quality, storage, seasonality, etc.).

4. Administrator Guide

The Admin Portal is a separate, desktop-friendly layout at `/admin/users`, `/admin/listings`, `/admin/disputes` — it has no bottom navigation and is English-only (it's an internal tool, not the farmer/buyer product). There is no public admin sign-up; an administrator account is created directly against the database by whoever runs the deployment (see the Maintenance & System Administration section of the Project Documentation), then logs in through the same phone+OTP screen as everyone else.

4.1 Users

List every farmer/buyer, optionally filtered by role. For any user: **Verify** (adds a trust badge visible to other users) or **Suspend** (blocks their next login/refresh — already-open sessions expire naturally rather than being force-killed).

4.2 Listings

See every listing regardless of status (the public marketplace only shows *Active* ones). Force a listing's status — most commonly, set a fraudulent or inappropriate listing to *Removed*; the farmer is notified.

4.3 Disputes

Shows every order currently *Disputed*, oldest first. Open one to see the full history — the amount, the farmer's Mobile Money details on file, the buyer's submitted transaction ID, and the farmer's rejection note. Resolve it one of two ways:

- **Uphold the payment** — you believe the buyer really did pay; the order becomes *Paid* and proceeds normally.
- **Uphold the rejection** — you believe the farmer is right; the order is *Cancelled* and the listing reopens for other buyers.

Both parties are notified of your decision either way — there is no third outcome and no way to reopen a resolved dispute from the UI (this is by design, to keep the audit trail clean).

5. SMS Command Reference (Feature Phones)

Text these commands to the FarmConnect SMS number — no smartphone, no app, no data plan required. Every command works whether or not you're already registered (except where noted).

Command	What it does
HELP	Replies with the full list of commands.
REG your name	Registers you as a Farmer using your phone number as your identity — no OTP needed over SMS.
MOMO mtn 024xxxxxxx	Links your Mobile Money network + number (required before LIST works). Networks: mtn , telecel , airteltigo .
LIST maize 200 3.50 Ashanti	Publishes a listing: crop, quantity (kg), price per kg, region.
PRICE maize	Replies with the current price for that crop.
ORDERS	Lists your open orders needing action.
CONFIRM 4f2a	Confirms a payment for the order whose ID ends in that code (shown in the ORDERS reply).

TRUST MODEL, STATED PLAINLY

The SMS channel treats possession of the phone number as proof of identity, with no OTP round-trip — the same trust boundary Mobile Money itself already relies on for its own USSD menus. Every inbound message is logged for audit regardless of outcome.

6. Notifications

The bell icon on every main screen shows an unread-count badge. Tap it to see every order, admin, and co-op event — each also arrives as an SMS if it's time-sensitive (order placed, payment submitted/confirmed/rejected, delivery confirmed, dispute resolved, account verified/suspended). A failed SMS never blocks the underlying action — you'll still see it in-app either way.

7. Language & Accessibility

- Switch between English and Twi (Akan) from the language toggle at any time — every farmer/buyer screen updates immediately.
- All buttons meet a minimum touch-target size for easy tapping on any screen size.
- Every icon-only button (back, attach photo, send, notification bell) has a screen-reader label; content photos have descriptive alt text.
- Keyboard users get a clearly visible focus outline on every field.

8. Troubleshooting & FAQ

I didn't get my OTP code

Wait a minute (SMS delivery can lag), then use "Resend code." Codes expire after 5 minutes. If it still doesn't arrive, your number may have hit the hourly request limit (protects against SMS abuse) — try again after an hour.

I can't publish a listing

You must link Mobile Money first (Profile → Mobile Money) — this is enforced by the app, not optional.

I paid but the farmer rejected it

Double-check the transaction ID and the number you paid from match exactly what you submitted. If you're sure it's correct, raise a dispute — an administrator will review your evidence.

The app looks stale / out of date

You may be offline — check for the offline banner at the top. Data shown while offline is the last version you saw online, not necessarily current.

The advisor says it's "not configured"

This means the deployment's AI provider key isn't set up yet — contact the administrator/deployer, not a bug in your account.

I want to become an Administrator

There's no self-service sign-up for this role — it's provisioned directly by whoever manages the deployment.